# Decode Your Trauma Seminar – Day 5 Recording Notes

📝 Decode Your Trauma: Day 5 Notes
🕒 Started at 8:35AM on 01 May 2026, lasted 31m

## Meeting Title: Decode Your Trauma – Day 5

🗓️ 01 May, 2026
👥 Alex Howard

### Outline

### ECHO Model Recap and Framework Overview

```
- The ECHO model serves as the structural framework for the five-day Decode
Your Trauma series, with each letter representing a stage in how past events
echo into present life.
- Days two through four covered the events of trauma, the context of core
emotional needs, and the shift in nervous system homeostasis into a
maladaptive stress response.
- Day five focuses on the fourth stage of the model, the outcomes of trauma,
and how to map a path toward healing.
```

### Outcomes of Trauma and Normalization

```
- Living with unresolved trauma leads individuals to normalize an inner
landscape that is far from optimal, cycling through hurt, pain, and suffering
on a daily basis without recognizing that change is possible.
- Trauma outcomes include anxiety, sleep issues, physical health problems,
relationship difficulties, addictions, and mood disturbances, all of which are
rooted in a dysregulated nervous system.
- Anxiety manifests as a constant attempt to think one's way to a feeling of
safety, rated on a scale of zero to ten based on current nervous system
regulation.
- Sleep quality is directly linked to nervous system regulation, with
disruptions appearing as difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking
unrefreshed, and poor sleep creates a self-reinforcing negative cycle of
fatigue and adrenalization.
- Physical health is affected because a dysregulated nervous system triggers
the cell danger response, shifting mitochondrial function away from energy
metabolism toward danger signaling, making trauma a contributing factor rather
than a sole cause of chronic health conditions.
- Relationship quality reflects early attachment patterns, with intimate and
```

self-relationships mirroring how core emotional needs were met in childhood.
- Addictions represent attempts to self-regulate or alter emotional states through substances or behaviors such as food, alcohol, drugs, sex, exercise, work, or social media scrolling, with the key issue being whether the individual controls the behavior or the behavior controls them.
- Mood disturbances, particularly depression, are often characterized not by intense sadness but by emotional numbness, narrowed emotional range, a sense of pointlessness, and hopelessness resulting from a shut-down, dysregulated nervous system.

## Nervous System Regulation as the Foundation for Healing

- Regulating the nervous system is identified as the central mechanism through which all six trauma outcomes can be improved.
- Approaching trauma processing from a dysregulated state is typically re-traumatizing, likened to a distressed child seeking comfort from a dysregulated parent.
- When the nervous system is calm and regulated, the emotional body, physical body, and mind all engage their natural healing capacities, much like how the body heals a physical wound once conditions are supportive.
- Returning to past events for processing is most effective and safe when done from a regulated, resourced state, and in many cases direct re-engagement with past events is not necessary if present-day outcomes have already shifted.

## The RESET Model for Nervous System Healing

- RESET is a five-stage acronym describing the process of resetting the nervous system and changing the outcomes of trauma.
- The first stage, Recognize, involves identifying that the system is operating in a maladaptive stress response.
- The second stage, Examine, involves exploring the narratives, beliefs, stories, and history that sustain the dysregulated state.
- The third stage, Stop, involves catching unhelpful thought patterns in the moment and interrupting them before they perpetuate further dysregulation.
- The fourth stage involves learning to connect with and feel emotions from a regulated state, allowing them to be metabolized and processed.
- The fifth stage, Transform, involves changing one's relationship with oneself, the body, and others as a result of the preceding stages.

## Neuroplasticity and Pattern Interruption

- Consistently stopping anxious thought patterns and replacing them with regulating responses trains the nervous system to respond differently over time.

- The principle that neurons that fire together wire together underpins the approach, meaning repeated new patterns of thinking and behavior become automatic through consistent practice.
- Therapeutic meditation, defined as meditation specifically adapted for therapeutic benefit, is presented as a complementary tool that trains the system toward a calmer baseline when practiced consistently.
- The stop process and therapeutic meditation work together, with meditation calming the system and the stop process preventing patterns from reactivating it.

## Emotional Processing and Integration

- Undigested emotions must be suppressed and held back at an ongoing energetic cost, making emotional processing a critical component of nervous system healing.
- An integrative approach is necessary because brain training alone without emotional connection causes the system to reactivate, while emotional work alone without addressing the mind leaves a key driver of dysregulation unresolved.
- Transforming the relationship with oneself has a cascading effect on all other areas of life including intimate relationships, health, family dynamics, and the ability to pursue meaningful goals.

## The Reset Programme

- The Reset Programme is a twelve-week online coaching program designed to teach participants how to reset the nervous system, switch off the maladaptive stress response, and cultivate a healing state.
- The programme draws on twenty-four years of clinical experience, over ten thousand hours of one-on-one therapy, supervision of thousands of patients, and interviews with hundreds of leading experts in trauma and nervous system healing.
- Five core components are included, covering weekly teaching modules of approximately one hour each that deliver frameworks, tools, tactics, and strategies for nervous system change.
- A knowledge base of answers to approximately fifteen hundred commonly asked questions is included, along with a team support channel for additional queries.
- Filmed mini sessions show real coaching interactions demonstrating the application of tools, a library of downloadable guided visualizations supports practice throughout daily life, and a community healing component rounds out the programme offering.

## Next Steps

```
- Participants are encouraged to use the provided assessment tool to receive a
personalized report summarizing how trauma has shown up for them individually.
- Enrollment in the twelve-week Reset Programme is presented as the
recommended continuation of the healing journey begun during the five-day
series.
- Consistent daily practice of therapeutic meditation and the stop process is
highlighted as the immediate practical path forward for nervous system
regulation.
```

## Key Points

- Purpose of the session is Day 5 of "Decode Your Trauma" — mapping the path to healing by understanding trauma outcomes and learning to reset the nervous system.
- ECHO model recap: Events, Context, and Homeostasis (Days 2–4) set the stage for Day 5's focus on Outcomes — how living in a dysregulated state shapes daily life.
- Normalizing to dysfunction is a core trauma outcome — people adapt to suppressing emotions, avoiding help, or intellectualizing safety without recognizing change is possible.
- Six key trauma outcomes identified: anxiety, sleep issues, physical health, relationships, addictions, and mood — each rooted in nervous system dysregulation.
- Depression reframed not as overwhelming sadness but as emotional numbness, narrowed range, and hopelessness — a product of a shut-down, dysregulated nervous system.
- Attachment styles (anxious, avoidant, disorganized) are directly linked to nervous system regulation — healing the nervous system often improves relationship patterns.
- Addictions framed as attempts to self-regulate — the goal is restoring freedom of choice so the person controls the behavior, not the other way around.
- Regulating the nervous system first is essential before revisiting past trauma — processing from a dysregulated state typically causes re-traumatization, not healing.
- RESET acronym introduced as a five-stage framework: Recognize, Examine, Stop, feel Emotions, and Transform — designed to progressively shift nervous system baseline.
- Neuroplasticity underpins the RESET approach — consistently interrupting anxious thought patterns and replacing them with regulated responses rewires automatic responses over time.
- Therapeutic meditation distinguished from standard mindfulness — specifically adapted for therapeutic benefit, it trains a calmer baseline state when practiced consistently.
- Integrating brain training with emotional processing is critical — working only on one without the other causes people to cycle without lasting progress.
- Undigested emotions consume energy to suppress — connecting to, processing, and healing underlying emotions is central to breaking the maladaptive stress response.
- Alex Howard's 12-week Reset Programme outlined: core weekly modules (~1 hour each), a 1,500-question knowledge base, filmed mini sessions, guided visualizations, and

team/coach access.

### Action Items

- [ ] N/A

## Themes

- Trauma and its lasting impact on adult life
- The ECHO model: Events, Context, Homeostasis, Outcomes
- Maladaptive stress response and nervous system dysregulation
- Core emotional needs: self-regulation, boundaries, self-worth
- Six outcomes of trauma: anxiety, sleep issues, health, relationships, addictions, mood
- Neuroplasticity and retraining the nervous system
- The RESET model as a framework for healing
- Attachment styles and their connection to nervous system states
- Therapeutic meditation and mindfulness as healing tools
- Emotional processing and integration
- The relationship between undigested emotions and physical/mental health
- Transforming relationships with self and others through healing

## Quotes

- "Those walls of defense, the things that we learned to do to survive the events of childhood, become the walls of the prism that trap us in our adult life." - Alex Howard
- "We're shaped by the past, but we intentionally learn to create our future the way that we want it to be." - Alex Howard
- "If you do that from a dysregulated place, it's typically re-traumatizing." - Alex Howard
- "Neurons that fire together wire together." - Alex Howard
- "When we're in a calm, regulated state, our emotional body heals, our physical body heals, our mind becomes clearer." - Alex Howard
- "Un-digested emotions have to go somewhere." - Alex Howard
- "If we change our relationship with ourself, every other relationship is being impacted by that." - Alex Howard